

Shivani Kumar, Ph.D.

Postdoctoral Research Fellow at University of Michigan

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RESEARCH INTEREST

I am a researcher in NLP and human-AI interaction. I design, analyze, and evaluate AI systems with a focus on human-centered dimensions of language, including affective and socio-cultural factors such as emotions, morality, culture, persuasion, and cooperation. My work investigates how AI systems understand, express, and explain these complex aspects of human communication, as well as how their behavior varies across languages, cultures, and varying social contexts.

EXPERIENCE

- **University of Michigan** May 2024 - Present
Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Ann Arbor, Michigan, USA
Advisor: Prof David Jurgens
Topic: Moral Values, Cultural Influence, and Large Language Models
- **Adobe Inc.** January 2023 - June 2023
PhD Intern
Noida, Uttar Pradesh, India
Mentors: Dr. Sumit Bhatia, Milan Aggarwal
Topic: Improving the efficacy of Conversational Systems

EDUCATION

- **Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology, Delhi (IIIT-Delhi)** 2019 - 2024
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) Delhi, India
 - Thesis Title: Understanding and Explaining Affective Traits in English and Code-mixed Conversations
 - Advisor: Prof. Tanmoy Chakraborty
 - Course Work Aggregate: 9.18 CGPA
- **University of Delhi – Department of Computer Science** 2017 - 2019
Masters of Sciences (M.Sc.) in Computer Science Delhi, India
 - Thesis Title: Using Complex Networks for Generating Concept Maps
 - Advisor: Prof. Vasudha Bhatnagar
 - Aggregate: 87.5%
- **University of Delhi – Shaheed Sukhdev College of Business Studies** 2014 - 2017
Bachelors of Sciences (B.Sc.) in Computer Science Delhi, India
 - Aggregate: 92.2%
- **Queen Marys School, Tis Hazari** 2002 - 2014
School Education Delhi, India
 - **Senior Secondary**, CBSE: 91.2%
 - **Secondary**, CBSE: 91.2%

PUBLICATIONS | CITATIONS: 418, H-INDEX: 9

Conference Publications

- [1] Johnathan Ivey*, **Shivani Kumar***, Jiayu Liu*, Hua Shen*, Sushrita Rakshit*, Rohan Raju*, Haotian Zhang*, Aparna Ananthasubramaniam*, Junghwan Kim*, Bowen Yi*, Dustin Wright*, Abraham Israeli*, Anders Giovanni Møller*, Lechen Zhang*, David Jurgens. [Real or Robotic? Assessing Whether LLMs Accurately Simulate Qualities of Human Responses in Dialogue](#). *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL) - Findings*, 2026.
- [2] **Shivani Kumar**, David Jurgens. [Are Rules Meant to be Broken? Understanding Multilingual Moral Reasoning as a Computational Pipeline with UniMoral](#). *Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2025. 🏆 **Best resource paper.**

- [3] **Shivani Kumar**, Md Shad Akhtar, Erik Cambria, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [SemEval 2024–Task 10: Emotion Discovery and Reasoning its Flip in Conversation \(EDiReF\)](#) *The North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL)*, 2024.
- [4] **Shivani Kumar**, Rishabh Gupta, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Adding SPICE to Life: Speaker Profiling in Multiparty Conversations](#) *Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING)*, 2024.
- [5] **Shivani Kumar**, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Harmonizing Code-mixed Conversations: Personality-assisted Code-mixed Response Generation in Dialogues](#). *Conference of the European Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (EACL) - Findings*, 2024.
- [6] **Shivani Kumar**, Ramaneswaran S, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [From Multilingual Complexity to Emotional Clarity: Leveraging Commonsense to Unveil Emotions in Code-Mixed Dialogues](#). *Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023.
- [7] **Shivani Kumar**, Ishani Mondal, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Explaining \(Sarcastic\) Utterances to Enhance Affect Understanding in Multimodal Dialogues](#). *Proceedings of the 37th AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI 2023)*.
- [8] **Shivani Kumar***, Atharva Kulkarni*, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [When did you become so smart, oh wise one?! Sarcasm Explanation in Multi-modal Multi-party Dialogues](#). *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2022)*.

Journal Publications

- [1] **Shivani Kumar**, Sumit Bhatia, Milan Aggarwal, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Dialogue Agents 101: A Beginner's Guide to Critical Ingredients for Designing Effective Conversational Systems](#) *Natural Language Processing (formerly Natural Language Engineering)*, 2024. [Impact Factor: 1.9 | Q1]
- [2] Pottay Kumar Adhikary, Aseem Srivastava, **Shivani Kumar**, Salam Michael Singh, Puneet Manuja, Jini K Gopinath, Vijay Krishnan, Swati Kedia, Koushik Sinha Deb, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Exploring the Efficacy of Large Language Models in Summarizing Mental Health Counseling Sessions: A Benchmark Study](#) *Journal of Medical Internet Research (JMIR)*, 2024. [Impact Factor: 6.0 | Q1]
- [3] Priyadarshini Rai, Atishay Jain, **Shivani Kumar**, Divya Sharma, Neha Jha, Smriti Chawla, Abhijit Raj, Apoorva Gupta, Sarita Poonia, Angshul Majumdar, Tanmoy Chakraborty, Gaurav Ahuja, Debarka Sengupta. [Literature mining discerns latent diseasegene relationships](#) *Bioinformatics*, 2024. [Impact Factor: 5.4 | Q1]
- [4] **Shivani Kumar**, Shubham Dudeja, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Emotion Flip Reasoning in Multiparty Conversations](#). *IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence*, 2023. [Impact Factor: 6.4 | Q1]
- [5] **Shivani Kumar**, Anubhav Shrimall, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Discovering Emotion and Reasoning its Flip in Multi-Party Conversations using Masked Memory Network and Transformer](#). *Knowledge-Based Systems*, 2022. [Impact Factor: 7.6 | Q1]
- [6] Manjot Bedi*, **Shivani Kumar***, Md Shad Akhtar, Tanmoy Chakraborty. [Multi-modal Sarcasm Detection and Humor Classification in Code-mixed Conversations](#). *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*, 2021. [Impact Factor: 9.8 | Q1]

Preprints and Extended Abstracts | (P: Preprint, E: Extended Abstract)

- [P2] **Shivani Kumar**, Adarsh Bharathwaj, and David Jurgens. [Cooperative Profiles Predict Multi-Agent LLM Team Performance in AI for Science Workflows](#). *ArXiv Preprint*, 2026.
- [E2] **Shivani Kumar** and David Jurgens. Modeling the Effectiveness of LLM Persuasion in Cooperative and Adversarial Settings. *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)*, 2026.
- [E1] **Shivani Kumar** and David Jurgens. Modeling LLM Persuasion via Interactive 2T1L Game *Midwest Speech and Language Days (MSLD)*, 2026.
- [P1] Sualeha Farid, Jayden Lin, Zean Chen, **Shivani Kumar**, and David Jurgens. [One Model, Many Morals: Uncovering Cross-Linguistic Misalignments in Computational Moral Reasoning](#). *ArXiv Preprint*, 2025.

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Selected for the Empowering Research with AI Award** Apr 2026
For our UNIMORAL Work.
- **Selected for the short-term scholarship program of DAAD Postdoc-NeT-AI** Oct 2025
Includes a three month grant for the awardee and the institute and travel allowance.
- **Selected for the University of Michigan Postdoctoral Association Travel Award** Aug 2025
For attending ACL 2025.
- **Selected as a DAAD AInet fellow for the Postdoc-NeT-AI** Oct 2024
Includes a virtual networking week and a one-week networking visit to Germany.
- **Microsoft Travel Grant, ACM-Woman Travel Grant** Nov 2023
For Travel to Singapore for EMNLP 2023.
- **Google Travel Grant, Microsoft Travel Grant, ACM-India Travel Grant (IARCS)** Apr 2022
For Travel to Dublin, Ireland for ACL 2022.
- **Junior Research Fellowship (JRF)** Jul 2019
Qualified UGC-NET, a standardized test by the University Grants Commission (UGC), India.

INVITED TALKS

- **Indian Institute of Science (IISc)** 2026
Talk on "Computational Social Intelligence for Human-Centered AI" Bengaluru, India
- **University of Texas - Rio Grande Valley** 2026
Talk on "Computational Social Intelligence for Human-Centered AI" Texas, USA
- **University of Chile** 2025
Talk on "Computational Social Intelligence for Human-Centered AI" Santiago, Chile
- **Annual German Academic International Network (GAIN) Conference** 2025
Science Slam about "Moral Reasoning using UNIMORAL" Boston, USA
- **3rd Symposium on NLP for Social Good** 2025
Talk on "Moral Reasoning using UNIMORAL" Virtual Event
- **Data Science/Computational Social Science (DS/CSS) seminar series** 2024
Science "Affective Traits of Natural Language" University of Michigan, USA
- **ACM-India's Symposium for Academic Research and Careers for Students** 2023
Lightning Talk and Poster Presentation NISER Bhubhaneshwar, India
- **International Conference on Natural Language Processing (ICON)** 2023
Tutorial on "Building Blocks of AI-Driven Mental Health Counseling" University of Goa, India
- **Google Research Week** 2024, 2023
Poster Presentation Bangalore, India

GUEST LECTURES

- **Lamarr Institute NLProc Colloquium** 2025
Title: "Affective Traits of Natural Language" University of Bonn, Germany
- **Applied Machine Learning course (SI-670)** 2024
Title: "Machine Learning for Sarcasm Analysis" University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, Michigan, USA
- **Research Methods in Social Science and Design (RMSSD) course (SSH201)** 2022, 2021, 2019
Title: "Social Media Analytics" IIIT-Delhi, India

IN NEWS

- **The University Record**  Apr 2026
Talks about the Empowering Research with AI Award for our ACL 2025 paper - "Are Rules Meant to be Broken? Understanding Multilingual Moral Reasoning as a Computational Pipeline with UNIMORAL"
- **The Science Archive**  Mar 2025
Talks about our ACL 2025 paper - "Are Rules Meant to be Broken? Understanding Multilingual Moral Reasoning as a Computational Pipeline with UNIMORAL"
- **UMSI Research Roundup**  Mar 2025
Talks about our ACL preprint - "Are Rules Meant to be Broken? Understanding Multilingual Moral Reasoning as a Computational Pipeline with UNIMORAL"

- **UMSI Research Roundup**

Dec 2024

Talks about our preprint - "Real or Robotic? Assessing Whether LLMs Accurately Simulate Qualities of Human Responses in Dialogue."

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

- **Co-Organiser at EDiReF** 2024
Shared Task in SemEval Workshop @ NAACL
- **Program Committee at ICON** 2022
International Conference on Natural Language Processing
- **Program Committee at CONSTRAINT** 2022
Workshop on Combating Online Hostile Posts in Regional Languages during Emergency Situation @ ACL
- **Co-Organiser at ACSS** 2021, 2020
Workshop on AI for Computational Social Systems
- **Co-Organiser at COFAD** 2020
Workshop on Combating Fraud Activities using Data Science

TEACHING ASSISTANT

- **Social Network Analysis** 2023, 2022
National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning (NPTEL) – an Indian MOOCs Platform
- **Social Network Analysis** 2022
Teaching Assistant at IIIT-Delhi
- **Machine Learning** 2021
Teaching Assistant at IIIT-Delhi
- **Natural Language Processing** 2021
Teaching Assistant for PG Diploma in Data Science and AI at IIIT-Delhi

COMMUNITY SERVICE

- **Area Chair** 2026
EACL, LREC
- **Reviewer** 2026
ICLR, TALLIP, TACL, ARR
- **Area Chair** 2025
ACL, EMNLP
- **Reviewer** 2025
ICLR, ARR, Neural Networks
- **Reviewer** 2024
ARR, ASONAM, WiNLP, Cluster Computing, IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence
- **Reviewer** 2023
ARR, EMNLP
- **Reviewer** 2022
EMNLP, ICON, CHI, DAFSAA
- **Student Mentor** 2022
For the "Desh ka Mentor" program of Delhi Government. Mentored four high school students.
- **Rapporteur** 2019
For The International Colloquium on Ethics and Governance of Autonomous AI Systems

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Fluent Languages: • English • Hindi

Interests: • Crocheting • Video Games • Photography • Reading • Writing • Art & Craft

PRIMARY REFERENCES

1. **Prof David Jurgens**
Associate Professor, School of Information
University of Michigan
Email: jurgens@umich.edu
Relationship: Postdoc Advisor
2. **Prof Tanmoy Chakraborty**
Associate Professor, Dept. of Electrical Engineering (Computer Technology Group); Associate Faculty
Member, Yardi School of Artificial Intelligence
Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IIT Delhi), India
Email: tanchak@iitd.ac.in, chak.tanmoy.iit@gmail.com*
Relationship: PhD Advisor
3. **Dr. Md Shad Akhtar**
Assistant Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Delhi
Email: shad.akhtar@iiitd.ac.in
Relationship: Mentor and Professor